
c. 1490–1545, ENGLISH

Although his career was fairly brief (most of his music was probably written in the 1520s), Taverner is regarded as the outstanding English composer of his time. In 1526, he became director of the choir at Cardinal Wolsey's magnificent new foundation in Oxford, Cardinal College (now called Christ Church). However, soon after Wolsey's downfall in 1529, Taverner returned to his native Lincolnshire and became a member of the choir at St. Botolph's Church, Boston. He seems to have retired from church music by 1537 and then lived the life of a prosperous gentleman. He wrote a few songs and instrumental pieces, but his music consists mainly of religious works, particularly Masses. His style has florid elements that link him to the Middle Ages, but also a sweeping sense of melody that is forward-looking.

KEY WORKS: Western Wynde Mass; Missa Corona spinea (Crown of Thorns Mass); Missa Gloria tibi Trinitas (Glory to You, O Trinity Mass); dates unknown

Tomás Luis de Victoria

1548–1611, SPANISH

Victoria was the towering figure of Spanish music of his